

Chapter 12: Sorry

Until the very end, Yan Lin never asked clearly whether Feng Yue had indeed not slept in the master bedroom for a long time. Although the answer was obvious, Yan Lin still held onto a little hope in her heart.

At least, in her previous life, they weren't like this.

There was no night light on the bedside table in the master bedroom, so Yan Lin could only turn on the smallest wall lamp in the bedroom to fall asleep. But the wall lamp, which was much brighter than a night light, kept her from sleeping as it was too dazzling.

Yan Lin opened her eyes with some frustration and looked at her phone - it was only 3 AM.

In her previous life, since Feng Yue's death, she could only sleep with a night light every night. She hadn't expected that coming to this side, it would still be the same.

Yan Lin sat up from the bed and rubbed her slightly aching temples. She glanced sideways at the cold and empty other half of the bed beside her, and an urgent feeling of wanting to see Feng Yue arose in her heart.

She lifted the covers, put on her slippers, opened the bedroom door, and walked straight to the nearby guest room.

Yan Lin stood at the tightly closed door of the guest room, head lowered, her long black curls falling freely over her shoulders. With one hand, she gently gripped the guest room door handle and pushed it open with a slight press.

The guest room door was gently pushed open without making any sound. Whether Feng Yue forgot to lock the door or didn't have the habit of locking doors, it certainly made things convenient for Yan Lin tonight.

The light seeping through the door crack allowed Yan Lin to see this guest room clearly. Unlike the cold appearance in Yan Lin's memory, Feng Yue had made some small arrangements to it.

Goose-yellow double-layered curtains, a floor lamp placed by the window along with a reclining chair, and next to it a small low table with several books casually placed on it - you could tell the books' owner had been reading them.

There was a desk in the guest room with a small succulent plant¹ on it, a closed laptop, and paper and pen placed beside it.

All of this looked full of the atmosphere of daily life.

Yan Lin's gaze fell on the figure lying under the covers. Feng Yue was sleeping soundly, curled up under the blanket.

Feng Yue lay on her side, curled up in the blanket. The air conditioning in the room was set quite low, and the humidifier on the bedside table was still working diligently, spraying fine water mist.

Yan Lin walked into the guest room, gently closed the door, then crouched down beside Feng Yue's bed, quietly gazing at the person who was sleeping peacefully with closed eyes.

The room was pitch black, with a disheveled woman crouching beside the bed. Anyone who saw this scene would scream in fright.

Yan Lin crouched there, her eyes already accustomed to the darkness, and she could even trace Feng Yue's features with her gaze in the dark.

This was the first time she had observed Feng Yue's facial features so carefully. Unlike what she had last seen in the hospital, the current Feng Yue had a rosy complexion full of vitality.

Only now did she finally have the real feeling that "Feng Yue is still alive."

Yan Lin didn't know how long she crouched by the bed, long enough for her brain to finally feel a trace of drowsiness. Only then did she stand up with her hands on her knees, relieved her numb legs, and quietly retreated from the guest room.

Yan Lin returned to her room and lay down. After thinking for a moment, she reached out and turned off the wall lamp. The room plunged into darkness, but this time the familiar suffocating sticky feeling didn't come. Instead, a sense of security rose from the bottom of her heart.

She no longer needed the night light - Feng Yue was appearing so vividly before her eyes.

At this time, Feng Yue, immersed in her dreams, once again recalled in her dreams things that had happened before.

Feng Yue, Yan Lin, and Fu Sixue, who had just graduated from middle school, all went directly to the high school division of Pearl Yuan Private School, except this time all three entered the same class.

Teenage girls entering high school always had countless troubles: the endless stream of academic tasks, difficult relationships with classmates, and the increasing number of confessions and advances received by their crush.

Fu Sixue quickly got along with new classmates with her outstanding social skills, but Feng Yue, originally warm and cheerful, missed quite a few opportunities to make friends because she stayed too close to the cold Yan Lin.

Everyone seemed to have a natural barrier against Yan Lin, and Feng Yue, who was close to her, was also blocked by that barrier.

But this barrier only applied to ordinary friends - those young men and women who harbored feelings for Yan Lin basically didn't have this concern.

Watching Yan Lin's suitors become more and more numerous and excellent, Feng Yue's heart became more anxious day by day.

At this time, Yan Lin didn't know Feng Yue's thoughts and still treated her like an ordinary friend.

Fu Sixue took in all of Feng Yue's restlessness, and finally one day made a bold suggestion to Feng Yue.

"Just confess directly. That way you'll stay by A-Lin's side as a suitor." Fu Sixue said lightly, biting her milk tea straw.

"How can that work!" Feng Yue lay on her desk with a worried expression, "I already made an agreement with her that we absolutely wouldn't date early."

Fu Sixue almost spat out her milk tea, saying skeptically, "A-Lin would make such a silly agreement with you? Don't tell me you made it up yourself?"

"What are you talking about! It's true. In our second year of middle school, she and I agreed not to date early."

Fu Sixue took a sip of milk tea and thought for a moment, "Then you should still go confess, but don't say anything about dating now. Just temporarily change your identity, otherwise if A-Lin really considers you a good friend or best friend, she definitely won't date you in the future." As she spoke, Fu Sixue winked mischievously.

Feng Yue: "..."

In any case, Feng Yue was eventually persuaded by Fu Sixue. She chose a weekend for her confession.

That weekend, she and Fu Sixue came to Yan Lin's house to study together as usual. Fu Sixue's idea was for her to confess when Yan Lin was walking her home in the evening. This way, even if she failed, they would each go to their own homes without awkwardness, and the next day after sleeping on it, she'd be ready to fight again.

Feng Yue, who had no experience, nodded foolishly. The three studied in the study room all morning, and after lunch they nestled in the game room to play games.

Midway, Yan's mother came to knock on the door asking if the three children wanted to go to the greenhouse with her to help. Feng Yue and Yan Lin obediently followed, while only Fu Sixue, who wasn't interested in the greenhouse, stayed in the game room.

Actually, going to help in the greenhouse just meant helping Yan's mother pick flowers. But halfway through picking, Yan's mother realized she forgot to bring the vase, so she turned back to get it, leaving the two of them to wander around the greenhouse first.

Warm sunlight streamed down from the transparent greenhouse roof, gently falling on Yan Lin's face, making those eyes particularly sparkling in the sunlight.

Feng Yue seemed transfixed, murmuring Yan Lin's name.

Hearing this, Yan Lin turned to look at her, and she appeared as if embedded among the blooming delicate flowers, harmonious and gorgeous.

"I like you." Feng Yue's voice was very soft.

But she knew Yan Lin had definitely heard it.

Yan Lin's calm face showed no trace of surprise. She just lowered her eyelashes, and even the sunlight couldn't fall into those eyes.

"Sorry."

Yan Lin's answer seemed to be within expectation, so Feng Yue didn't feel particularly sad. She only had a sense of relief that things should be this way.

Yan Lin was like a flower blooming on a cliff - countless people flocked to her, but no one truly obtained her. Even the small grass that had always grown beside her couldn't.

No blade of grass could possess a flower.

Later, when Feng Yue went home, she took with her the rose that had been behind Yan Lin at that time - a rose that had been misplaced by the gardener and didn't belong to the Yan family greenhouse.

Feng Yue brought this rose home to care for it carefully, hoping that one day, that blade of grass could truly possess this rose.

Feng Yue opened her eyes to see sunlight streaming through the curtains from outside, falling on her outstretched hand.

The sunlight in her dream that day seemed just as bright and warm, making even the cold Yan Lin seem to warm up.

Feng Yue believed that the apology from that time was the most weighty sentence Yan Lin had ever said to her, while last night's was the most casual.

Feng Yue's thoughts drifted far away, until her phone rang with a message notification.

Feng Yue looked at her phone, at the person who sent the message, quite surprised. If her contact name was still valid, then the person contacting her was her high school and middle school classmate, the girl who had made possible her collaboration with Yan Lin - Zhou Qiongqiong.

Zhou Qiongqiong: Dear friends from Class 2, this Friday at 7 PM, dinner at JT Club. Just mention Pearl Yuan High School's name to enter~ Please reply before noon tomorrow so I can count the numbers~

Feng Yue looked at this message and could basically confirm it was 100% a group message.

Speaking of high school, she didn't have particularly deep impressions. Both she and Yan Lin had top-tier grades, plus Yan Lin's increasingly cold personality as she grew up, so almost no one took the initiative to communicate with them.

Although she herself was very enthusiastic, when faced with choosing between Yan Lin and other classmates, her choice was always one and only one.

She didn't think making friends was better than staying by Yan Lin's side.

Later, when their only social butterfly Fu Sixue went abroad, they had even less interaction with others.

She still remembered that she and Yan Lin had never attended any previous high school reunions.

Because Yan Lin couldn't get away, she didn't want to go either.

But looking at this message now, Feng Yue felt for the first time that she should go out and make friends.

Even if she couldn't make new friends, she should at least strengthen her relationships with high school classmates.

Feng Yue moved her fingers and replied to Zhou Qiongqiong's message, then got up to wash up.

When she picked up her phone again after washing up, Zhou Qiongqiong had sent several messages.

Zhou Qiongqiong: ?

Zhou Qiongqiong: Are you Feng Yue?

Zhou Qiongqiong: Don't tell me your account was hacked? Do you know who I am?

Feng Yue: Zhou Qiongqiong, I wasn't hacked. I'm Feng Yue, and I'll come to the reunion on Friday.

Feng Yue: How's that? Clear enough?

Zhou Qiongqiong: ...

Zhou Qiongqiong: ...amazing

Zhou Qiongqiong: Clear enough. But will you really come? It feels like you've never participated before!

Feng Yue felt a bit embarrassed and rubbed her nose, then continued typing to explain.

Feng Yue: Sorry about that. I really couldn't get away before, but now it's fine. I'm always at home with nothing to do, so I'll definitely come.

Zhou Qiongqiong: Great! Of the two reunions each year, you and Yan Lin are the most mysterious. Everyone would be very happy if you could come.

Looking at this message, Feng Yue felt for the first time that Zhou Qiongqiong's personality wasn't so bad - as if that proud and conceited middle school Zhou Qiongqiong had grown up.

Feng Yue: Sounds good, see you there!

Footnotes:

¹ **Succulent plant (多肉):** Small, fleshy plants that are popular as low-maintenance houseplants, often kept on desks or windowsills.